

Sep 25, 2025

d) Geometric Random Variable

$$X \sim \text{Geo}(p), p \in (0, 1]$$

$$P_X(x) = p(1-p)^{x-1}, x \in \mathbb{N}$$

number of independent Bernoulli trials needed until the first success is observed

$$X \sim \text{Geo}_0(p), P_X(x) = p(1-p)^x, x \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$$

Exercise: $X \sim \text{Geo}_0(p)$ or $Y \sim \text{Geo}(p)$

$$\text{show } \sum_{x=0}^{\infty} P_X(x) = 1 \text{ or } \sum_{y=1}^{\infty} P_Y(y) = 1$$

i) $X \sim \text{Geo}_0(p)$

$$P_X(x) = p(1-p)^x$$

$$\rightarrow \sum_{x=0}^{\infty} p(1-p)^x = \frac{p}{1-(1-p)} = 1$$

ii) $Y \sim \text{Geo}(p)$

$$P_Y(y) = p(1-p)^{y-1}$$

$$\rightarrow \sum_{y=1}^{\infty} p(1-p)^{y-1} = \frac{p}{1-(1-p)} = 1$$

e) Poisson Random Variable

$$X \sim \text{Pois}(\lambda)$$

$$P_X(x) = \frac{\lambda^x}{x!} e^{-\lambda}, x = 0, 1, 2, \dots$$

$$\sum_{x=0}^{\infty} P_X(x) = \sum_{x=0}^{\infty} e^{-\lambda} \frac{\lambda^x}{x!} = e^{-\lambda} \cdot e^{\lambda} = 1$$

Poisson Distribution as a limit of the binomial

$$\lambda = np$$

$$\frac{n!}{x!(n-x)!} p^x (1-p)^{n-x} \approx e^{-\lambda} \frac{\lambda^x}{x!}$$

assume $X_n \sim \text{Bin}(n, \frac{\lambda}{n})$

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} P_{X_n}(x) &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{n!}{x!(n-x)!} \left(\frac{\lambda}{n}\right)^x \left(1 - \frac{\lambda}{n}\right)^{n-x} \\ &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\lambda^x}{x!} \cdot \frac{n!}{(n-x)! n^x} \cdot \left(1 - \frac{\lambda}{n}\right)^n \left(1 - \frac{\lambda}{n}\right)^{-x} \\ &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(1 - \frac{\lambda}{n}\right)^n \cdot \frac{\lambda^x}{x!} = e^{-\lambda} \cdot \frac{\lambda^x}{x!} \end{aligned}$$

f) Negative Binomial

$X \sim \text{NegB}(k, p)$; number of independent Bernoulli trials until success is seen k times

$$\begin{aligned} P_X(x) &= \binom{x-1}{k-1} p^k (1-p)^{x-k} \\ &= \binom{x-1}{k-1} p^k (1-p)^{x-k}, \quad x \geq 1, x \geq k \end{aligned}$$

g) Power Law Distribution

i) Zipf - Mandelbrot Distribution

$$P_X(x) = \frac{c}{(x+q)^x} \quad x=1, 2, \dots, N$$

$$\sum_{x \in \mathbb{N}} P_X(x) = 1 = \sum \frac{c}{(x+q)^x}$$

$$c = 1 / \sum \frac{1}{(x+q)^x}$$

ii) Hurwitz Zeta function $\zeta(x, q)$

$$P_x(z) = \frac{c}{(x+q)^x}$$

iii) Another Power Law

$$P_x(z) = \frac{1}{z^x} - \frac{1}{(z+1)^x} \quad x \in \mathbb{N}, x > 0$$

Exercise: Show $\sum_{x \in \mathbb{N}} P_x(z) = 1$

$$S_1 = \frac{1}{1^x} - \frac{1}{2^x}$$

$$S_2 = \frac{1}{1^x} - \frac{1}{2^x} + \frac{1}{2^x} - \frac{1}{3^x}$$

$\vdots$

$$\therefore \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} S_n = \sum_{x \in \mathbb{N}} P_x(z) = 1 - \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{n^x} = 1 \quad \forall x > 0$$